

current top-line of devices have, Toray's film does not rely just on the oil-repelling properties, but on the texture of these oleophobic coatings as well. The small 'nano-wrinkles' are invisible to the eye but they make the fingerprint less visible due to their structure, and the way it reflects light. So this film not just repels oil, but also decreases the visibility



Toray's film is coated on the glass piece on the right

of smudges. We are expecting other such technologies as companies look to reduce the distracting reflections and smudges.

Processor

The current tablets, and all other handhelds, run almost exclusively on ARM-based processors. Apple devices are all based on ARM architecture, and so were Android devices until very recently. This has been a tectonic shift of sorts, as Intel had dominated while desktops and laptops were hot. A part of the reason for this was that ARM processors have historically been much more power efficient. While Intel was going for clock speeds in excess of 3.0GHz, the slower-clocked and power efficient ARM processors were a perfect fit for the initial smartphones which never really had aspirations to compete with PC for power. Fast forward a few years, and we see a constant dip in PC sales year-on-year, and a constant increase in the processing power of ARM chips.

Intel would not give up without a fight, and has released a rather impressive first iteration of its mobile-minded processor architecture, Medfield. Android now supports the Intel architecture, and the initial benchmarks on the early handsets have shown that the age old adage of Intel processors being inefficient doesn't really hold true for the new architecture. Already, the single core Medfield is running neck to neck with quad-core ARM equivalents. So, looking in the glass orb, we can see Intel devices bringing more competition to the tablet space.

One of the most significant releases in the following year would be the ARM Cortex-A15 based devices. The flagship Cortex architecture is touted